

Goals can take form of missions, operations, saving your princess, killing the boss enemy etc.

Theme

Theme or story is the element of a game which is least recognized. Mario Bros. is a game about a plumber on a quest to save a princess; how many even know this. But still, a game needs to have a theme or a back-ground story line on which characters, game-world is created. Theme is the base of visual elements in the game. Sometimes, it even helps in addition of some Game Mechanics. Mechanics that evolve from the theme may be unique of your theme is unique. While you choose a theme for your game, think of something that interests you the most, research about it and try to gamify it. Now that that's out of the way and you understand the concepts, let's move on. Where were we? Ah, the Design phase.

The game design process

The game design process is divided into three stages:

- a. The game idea and concept stage
- b. Taking an idea to a formal concept
- c. Taking care of game-design constraints

a. The game idea and concept stage

Any game starts with an idea. But where do Designers get ideas from? Do they decide the Game Mechanics first and then work their way to the aesthetics and creating a theme to suit it? Or do they think of a game-world and apply proper mechanics to it? For a Game Designer, it can start anywhere.

Generating a game idea

Some start with Aesthetics and work their way back to the Dynamics and Mechanics. But majority of the designs start with mechanics which is then followed to aesthetics. According to the MDA framework, one can think of a game as a sphere, with the Mechanics at the core, the Dynamics surrounding them, and the Aesthetics on the surface, each layer growing out of the one inside it. Conversely, a player sees the surface first – the Aesthetics. Some players may be aware of the Mechanics and Dynamics, but aesthetics makes an immediate impression that is most



The MDA framework